

The people, and Malachi. Priests, reprov'd.

and a seruant his Master. If then I be a father, where is mine honour: and if I be a Master, where is my feare, saith the LORD of hostes, vnto you O priests, that despise my name: and yee say, wherein haue we despised thy name:

|| Or, bring vnto &c.

7 || Yee offer polluted bread vpon mine altar: and yee say, wherein haue we polluted thee: In that yee say, The table of the LORD is contemptible.

† Heb. to sacrifice.

8 And if hee offer the blind † for sacrifice, is it not euill: and if yee offer the lame and sicke, is it not euill: offer it now vnto thy gouernour: Will he be pleased with thee, or accept thy person, saith the LORD of hostes:

† Heb. the face of God.
† Heb. from your hand.

9 And now I pray you, beseech † God, that hee will be gracious vnto vs: this hath bene † by your meanes: Will he regard your persons, saith the LORD of hostes:

* Isai. i. 11.
ier. 6. 20.
amos. 5. 21.

10 Who is there euen among you that would shut the doores for nought? neither doe yee kindle fire on mine altar for nought. I haue no pleasure in you, saith the LORD of hostes, neither will I accept an * offering at your hand.

11 For from the rising of the Sunne, euen vnto the going downe of the same my name shall be great among the Gentiles, and in euery place incense shall be offered vnto my name, and a pure offering: for my name shall be great among the heathen, saith the LORD of hostes.

12 ¶ But yee haue prophaned it, in that yee say: The table of the LORD is polluted, and the fruite thereof, euen his meate, is contemptible.

|| Or, where as you might haue blown it away.

13 Yee said also: Behold what a wearinesse is it, and || yee haue snuffed at it, saith the LORD of hostes, and yee brought that which was torne, and the lame, and the sicke: thus yee brought an offering: should I accept this of your hand, saith the LORD:

† Heb. in whose flocks is.

14 But cursed be the deceiuer, which hath in his flocke a male, and bo weth and sacrificeth vnto the Lord a corrupt thing: for I am a great King, saith the LORD of hostes, and my name is dreadfull among the heathen.

CHAP. II.

1 He sharply reproveth the Priests for neglecting their covenant. 11 and the people for idolatry, 14 for adulterie, 17 and for infidelitie.

And now, O yee Priests, this commaundment is for you.

2 If ye will not heare, and if yee will not lay it to heart, to giue glory vnto my name, saith the LORD of hostes: I will euen send a * curse vpon you, and will curse your blessings: yea, I haue cursed them already, because yee doe not lay it to heart.

* Leuit. 26.
24. deut. 28
15.

3 Behold, I will corrupt your seed, and spread doung vpon your faces, euen the doung of your solemne feasts, and || one shall take you away with it.

|| Or, reprove.
† Heb. scatter.
|| Or, as shall take you away to it.

4 And yee shall know that I haue sent this commaundment vnto you, that my covenant might be with Leui, saith the LORD of hostes.

5 My covenant was with him of life and peace, and I gaue them to him, for the feare, wherewith he feared mee, and was afraid before my name.

6 The law of truth was in his mouth, and iniquitie was not found in his lips: he walked with me in peace and equitie, and did turne many away from iniquitie.

7 For the priests lips should keepe knowledge, and they should seeke the law at his mouth: for he is the messenger of the LORD of hostes.

8 But yee are departed out of the way: ye haue caused many to stumble at the law: ye haue corrupted the covenant of Leui, saith the LORD of hostes.

|| Or, fall in the law.

9 Therefore haue I also made you contemptible and base before all the people, according as yee haue not kept my wayes, but || haue bin partiall in y^e law.

|| Or, lifted up the face against. Heb. accepted faces.
* Eph. 4. 6.

10 * Haue we not all one father: hath not one God created vs: why doe we deale treacherously euery man against his brother, by prophaning the covenant of our fathers:

11 ¶ Judah hath dealt treacherously, and an abomination is committed in Israel and in Ierusalem: for Judah hath prophaned the holinesse of the LORD which || he loued, and hath married the daughter of a strange God.

|| Or, ought to loue.

12 The LORD will cut off the man that doth this: the || Master and the scholler out of the tabernacles of Jacob, and him that offereth an offering vnto the LORD of hostes.

|| Or, him that waketh and him that answereth.

13 And this haue yee done againe, couering the Altar of the LORD with teares,